

Receipt Processing Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

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Owner: Operations QA

Classification: Internal Use — Authoritative Procedure

1. Objective

Provide a consistent process for intake, validation, reconciliation, exception handling, and recommendation generation for receipt and invoice submissions.

2. Scope

Applies to:

- Expense receipts
- Hotel invoices
- Utility statements
- Supporting reimbursement documents
- Mobile expense submissions

Does not apply to:

- Budget planning files
 - Commentary documents
 - Draft notes without supporting evidence
- ### 3. Processing Sequence

STEP 1 — Intake Validation

Verify submission contains:

- Expense identifier
- Supporting attachment
- Employee reference
- Transaction amount
- Submission timestamp

If mandatory fields are missing → move to HOLD.

STEP 2 — Document Extraction

Extract:

- Merchant
- Transaction date
- Amount
- Category indicators
- Invoice or reference identifiers

If extraction confidence is insufficient:

- Preserve original values
- Escalate to manual review
- Do not infer missing values

STEP 3 — Vendor Normalization

Normalize merchant values against approved vendor records.

Examples:

- Variants may map to one normalized merchant.
- Raw receipt text never becomes authoritative without validation.

If normalization fails:

→ Route to REVIEW.

STEP 4 — Duplicate Reconciliation (Mandatory Before Approval)

Match using this order:

Priority 1:

Exact receipt signature

Priority 2:

Merchant + Date + Amount

Priority 3:

Invoice Reference

Priority 4:

Historical reimbursement

Priority 5:

Billing period uniqueness

Duplicate detection takes precedence over approval readiness.

STEP 5 — Policy Validation

Check:

- Category eligibility
- Required documents
- Approval thresholds
- Restricted categories
- Missing business justification

Policy outcomes:

PASS

REVIEW

HOLD

REJECT

STEP 6 — Workflow Verification

Current workflow state must be checked before recommendations.

Rules:

- Processed records remain immutable
- Approved $\neq$ reimbursed
- Pending approvals remain unchanged
- Held records require manual completion

STEP 7 — Recommendation Generation

Produce:

1. Outcome first
2. Short evidence summary
3. Duplicate findings
4. Missing support
5. Threshold concerns
6. Draft-only follow-up if needed

Do not:

- Execute approvals
- Trigger reimbursement
- Change state
- Send messages

STEP 8 — Exception Handling

Use exception archive only for examples.

Historical outcomes:

- Never override policy
- Never override registry
- Never override workflow

STEP 9 — Final Decision Matrix

APPROVE

Complete evidence + no conflict

REVIEW

Evidence exists but needs validation

HOLD

Missing document or unresolved discrepancy

REJECT

Policy violation

NO ACTION

Already processed or historical duplicate

10. Audit Requirements

Every recommendation must be reproducible from authoritative artifacts.

When records conflict:

Procedure > Policy Thresholds > Registry > Workflow > Notes

End of SOP